

DecodeMyCare - Project info

Project Background

Decode My Care™ is a browser-based, role-sensitive solution designed to enhance the post-visit experience for Veterans, caregivers, and frontline community allies. Grounded in plain-language guidance and health literacy principles, the tool provides actionable support following discharge or telehealth encounters, helping Veterans navigate care transitions with greater clarity, calm, and connection.

Website: <https://www.decodemycare.com/>

Decode My Care Concept Paper | VA Suicide Prevention BAA (Topic 0002)

Overview and Objectives

Veteran suicide remains a national crisis, with approximately 17 Veterans dying by suicide each day. More than half of those who die were not engaged in VHA or VBA services at the time, and suicide risk is highest in the 30 to 90 days following care transitions. Decode My Care™ is a browser-based, role-sensitive digital companion that helps Veterans and their circles of care, caregivers, family, and community allies, navigate these vulnerable periods with greater clarity, calm, and connection.

The tool translates discharge instructions and follow-up guidance into plain-language, step-by-step pathways tailored to each user's role. By removing common barriers such as login requirements, technical complexity, or inaccessible language, Decode My Care™ helps reduce confusion and disconnection, two key drivers of suicide risk, and supports Veterans in taking clear next steps after care ends.

Current Gaps in Post-Discharge Support

Today, Veterans are typically given written discharge instructions or directed to portals that are technically comprehensive but not always practical or accessible. This can lead

to confusion, non-compliance, missed care, and social withdrawal, all of which heighten the risk of suicide after care transitions. Many Veterans face barriers using existing tools due to login issues, technology friction, or physical limitations. Those not connected to VHA or caregivers are at higher risk, left with no structured follow-up or guidance at times when suicide risk is highest.

Innovative Approach

Decode My Care™ extends plain-language guidance beyond the clinical setting, delivering stepwise support directly into the hands of Veterans and their chosen supporters. By offering easy-to-follow steps during the most confusing moments after care, Decode My Care™ reduces stress and restores clarity when Veterans and their supporters need it most.

The experience is intentionally simple and emotionally supportive yet backed by structured AI logic that can evolve over time. We will use our BridgePath™ training and enablement framework to support structured onboarding, feedback collection, and role-specific reinforcement during pilot deployment and scale-up phases.

Impact on Suicide Prevention

Veteran suicide claims an estimated 17 lives per day in the United States. More than 50 percent of these deaths occur among those not actively engaged in VHA or VBA care. Risk spikes in the 30 to 90 days after discharge or care transitions, precisely when instructions fade, follow-up is unclear, and isolation can grow.

Decode My Care™ empowers caregivers, family, battle buddies, clergy, and peers, not just clinicians, to observe, guide, and support the Veteran in real time using tools designed for suicide prevention, not just generic health navigation. By supporting upstream clarity and connection, this tool strengthens hope and safety, preventing crises and suicide at the most vulnerable points.

Progress and Readiness

The Decode My Care™ MVP is active and under continuous refinement. The current version includes multiple role-based pathways and a functioning logic model. We are actively using Replit and Voiceflow to simulate user flows, emotional tone, and decision branching, enabling rapid prototyping without building full infrastructure prematurely.

As of this submission, the tool:

- Operates across desktop and mobile browsers
- Allows MVP users to navigate pathways based on role and recent care activity

- Does not store personal health information or require user login
- Has been tested with internal and simulated real-world discharge scenarios
- Reflects feedback from my experience as a nurse, caregiver, and friend, as well as informal peer interviews with Veterans, family members, and frontline support roles

We are now preparing for cloud migration to enable pilot deployment. Accessibility improvements are underway, including voice interaction prototyping, simplified navigation, and formatting for screen readers. We are also preparing cultural and tone adaptations for trusted supporters such as caregivers, battle buddies, clergy, and peer mentors. The architecture and content strategy are being developed with scalability in mind, allowing future deployments across VA facilities, community partner sites, or rural care networks without requiring full rebuilds. The tool is deployable at both the facility and VISN level, enabling flexible pilot and scale-up across the VA system.

Delivery Framework and Team

Our cross-functional team brings experience in Veteran engagement, health technology, clinical care, caregiver support, and government contracting. BridgePath™ is both our implementation framework and our guiding principles designed to bridge post-care gaps and create new, role-based paths of engagement for Veterans and those who support them. We will use the BridgePath™ framework to ensure smooth adoption across pilot sites, with targeted training and guided implementation for each role type. This includes onboarding for Veterans, caregivers, and trusted community supporters.

Innovation Value Statement

Decode My Care™ delivers measurable suicide prevention innovation by focusing on what happens after care, closing a gap where many Veterans are lost to follow-up, and where the risk for suicide peaks. Our value is in supporting Veterans not engaged in VHA or VBA, increasing clarity and support during care transitions, and offering actionable, role-based guidance to help prevent suicide in real-world scenarios. Future enhancements will continue to prioritize suicide risk reduction, not only by maintaining privacy and safety, but by extending the model to even more at-risk Veterans and their networks, preventing suicide before a crisis can occur. BridgePath™ and backend AI refinement will ensure scalable delivery and responsiveness over time, without replacing clinical judgment or relying on chat-based interaction.

Screenshots from Replit:

Below is the AI prompt used by client:

Build a modern, emotionally mindful web app called ****Decode My Care™**** that helps people navigate what to do after any medical interaction — whether a hospital stay, clinic visit, telemedicine appointment, or urgent care.

The goal is to reduce anxiety, prevent unnecessary ER visits, and provide calm, plain-language guidance for patients, caregivers, and community supporters.

Step 1: Caring Welcome Screen

Start with a warm, compassionate message:

****Welcome to Decode My Care™****

You've just been through a medical visit—maybe at a hospital, during telemedicine, or with your doctor.

We know that even after care ends, the questions don't.

If you've ever left feeling confused, unsure, or like you missed something important—you're not alone.

We're here to help you make sense of it all. Simply. Clearly. With care.

No downloads. No logins. Just support when you need it most.

Ask:

****“Who's using this today?”****

(Select to personalize your experience — no login required.)

Offer 3 buttons:

1. I am a patient

2. I am a caregiver

3. I am a community supporter or guide (EMS, case manager, peer counselor, faith leader, or friend)

Then show these brief, role-specific messages:

- ****Patient:****

“We're here to help you feel steady and supported after your visit. One step at a time.”

- ****Caregiver:****

— “Thank you for being there. We know it’s hard sometimes — let’s make this part easier together.” —

- **Community Supporter:**

— “Thank you for showing up.

You don’t have to be a family member or a clinician to make a difference. Whether you’re an EMS professional, a faith leader, or simply a trusted voice — your support matters.

We’re here to help you feel confident guiding someone through their care.” —

Step 2: Homepage Layout

Include:

- **Headline:** “Your calm companion after any medical visit”

- **Subheadline:** “Plain-language guidance to help you move forward with confidence.”

- **Buttons:**

- Start Your Guidance
- Search Topics

- **Search bar** with placeholder examples:

— “wound care”, “when to call the doctor”, “medication timing” —

- **Featured sections (cards):**

- Medications
- Follow-Up Instructions
- Comfort & Daily Care

Brand Colors and UI Design:

- **Primary Purple:** `#6B4C9A` → section headers, key labels

- **Accent Teal:** `#3FBAC2` → buttons, highlights, checkmarks

- **Background:** `#F9FAFB` (soft, clean)

- **Text:** `#444444` (readable, warm)

Avoid harsh contrasts or clinical tones. Prioritize accessibility, simplicity, and emotional calm.

Additional Features:

- Print/save buttons for each section

- Mobile responsive

- One sample topic walkthrough (e.g., “Cough after surgery”) using green/yellow/red icon indicators and plain language guidance

- No login or user account required



💡 Experience Goals:

- Calm people after care
- Clarify confusing instructions
- Prevent avoidable ER visits
- Support families and community helpers
- Feel like a hand on your shoulder — not just another app

Webapp Screenshots

Welcome to Decode My Care™

You've just been through a medical visit maybe at a hospital, during telemedicine, or with your doctor.

We know that even after care ends, the questions don't.

If you've ever left feeling confused, unsure, or like you missed something important **you're not alone.**

We're here to help you make sense of it all. Simply. Clearly. With care.

No downloads. No logins. Just support when you need it most.

Who's using this today?

Select to personalize your experience. No login required.

I am a patient

I am a caregiver

I am a community supporter or guide

Your calm companion after any medical visit

Plain-language guidance to help you move forward with confidence.

Start Your Guidance

Search Topics

Search for guidance: wound care, when to call the doctor, medication timing...



Find guidance for your needs



Medications

Understanding your prescriptions, timing, and what to watch for.

- ✓ Dosage instructions
- ✓ Side effects to watch
- ✓ When to call your doctor



Follow Up Instructions

Making sense of your next steps and appointment scheduling.

- ✓ Appointment scheduling
- ✓ Test result understanding
- ✓ Recovery timeline



Comfort & Daily Care

Practical tips for recovery and feeling better at home.

- ✓ Pain management
- ✓ Activity restrictions
- ✓ Daily living tips

Sample: Cough after surgery

Here's how we help you understand when to worry and when to rest easy.

Normal & Expected

Watch Carefully

 Call Now

Sample: Cough after surgery

Here's how we help you understand when to worry and when to rest easy.

Normal & Expected

- Dry cough for 2 to 3 days after anesthesia
- Mild throat irritation
- Cough that gets better each day

What to do: Rest, stay hydrated, use throat lozenges

Watch Carefully

- Cough lasting more than 5 days
- Cough getting worse instead of better
- Producing small amounts of clear mucus

What to do: Call your doctor's office during business hours

Call Now

- Coughing up blood or pink foam
- Severe shortness of breath
- Chest pain with coughing

What to do: Call your doctor immediately or go to ER

Print Guide

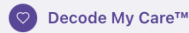
Save for Later

Need immediate help?

Emergency: 911

Nurse Line: 811

Find Urgent Care

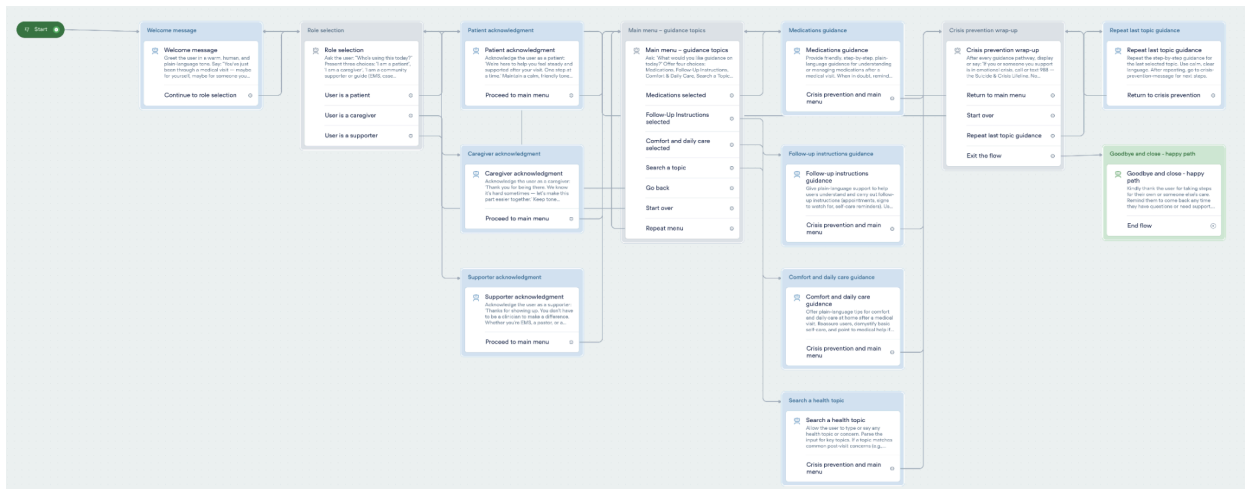


Simply. Clearly. With Care.

This tool provides general guidance and should not replace professional medical advice.

If you or someone you support is in emotional crisis, call or text **988** the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline.

Voice AI Configs



Technical Solutioning

Customer Journey

Landing Page -> Main Page -> Search option
-> Topics (Priority wise)

Voice Calling -> Follow instructions -> Search Topic Wise -> Respond by following instructions

Tech Solution Draft

Knowledge, Topics,

1. Web App

Admin View:

- Admin panel
- Build Agent for each topics

User View:

- Display topics based on priority or selection
 - Search option to show results from topics
1. Voice AI App

Admin:

- Build Agent character
- Integration with Web App Agent

User:

- Search option to communicate results from topics

Project

2 Stages:

1. MVP Stage - Current Requirement
2. Post MVP Stage - HIPAA compliant - Later

Need

1. Architecture:
2. Timeline:
3. Resources:
4. Cost for development
5. Estimation for Infrastructure cloud deployment, AI tools, voice AI tools